

Susan Pit

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Education

Ph.D. Earth Sciences <i>University of California, Santa Cruz</i>	2022 – present
M.Sc. Marine Sciences, cum laude <i>Utrecht University, Utrecht (Netherlands)</i>	2017 –2019
B.Sc. Liberal Arts and Sciences, cum laude <i>University College Utrecht, Utrecht (Netherlands)</i>	2014 - 2017

Publications

Vollebregt, A., van Helmond, N. A., **Pit, S.**, Kraal, P., & Slomp, C. P. (2023). Trace metals as a redox proxy in Arabian Sea sediments in and below the oxygen minimum zone. *Chemical Geology*, 121300. doi.org/10.1016/j.chemgeo.2022.121300

Awards, Honors, and Research Grants

Ken Norris Student Research Award , University of California – Santa Cruz	2025
NSF INTERN Award , Oak Ridge National Lab	2024
J. Casey Moore Award , University of California – Santa Cruz	2023
Oceanographic & Marine Biology Research Grant , Myers Trust	2023
Dean’s Research Travel Grant , University of California – Santa Cruz	2022, 2023, 2024, 2025
Regent’s Fellowship , University of California – Santa Cruz	2022
Earth & Planetary Sciences Department Fellowship , University of California – Santa Cruz	2019
Olaf Schuiling Fund Research Grant , Utrecht University	2017
Olaf Schuiling Fund Research Grant , Utrecht University	2014

Presentations

Talks

- Pit, S.**, (2026) *Methanogenesis in a Salicornia-Dominated Coastal Salt Marsh*. Graduate Seminar series, UC Santa Cruz. [Seminar]
- Pit, S.**, Chuang, P. C., & Paytan, A. (2025) *Reactive transport modelling of subsurface carbon dynamics in a pristine salt marsh on the Pacific coast*. Goldschmidt Conference Prague, Czech Republic. [Conference]
- Pit, S.**, (2025) *Quantifying Organic Matter Degradation in Elkhorn Slough Marshes*. Annual Wetlands Meeting, UC Santa Cruz. [Symposium]
- Pit, S.**, (2024) *Elkhorn Slough Subsurface Carbon Dynamics*. Annual Wetlands Meeting, UC Santa Cruz. [Symposium]
- Pit, S.**, (2024) *Subsurface Carbon Cycling in Tidal Salt Marshes*. Graduate Seminar series, UC Santa Cruz. [Seminar]

Posters

- Pit, S.**, Paytan, A. (2025) *Whodunnit? Subsurface Methane Oxidation in a Pristine Salt Marsh*. Annual Department Symposium, UC Santa Cruz.
- Pit, S.**, Paytan, A., Chuang, P. C., Hermosillo, N., Galindo-Eguiarte, V., & Osleger, L. (2023) *Subsurface carbon dynamics in diverse coastal wetland settings at the Elkhorn Slough National Estuarine Research Reserve*. Goldschmidt Conference, Lyon, France.
- Pit S.**, Cui, X., Paytan A., Jeppesen R., & Haskins J. (2021) *Trace Metal Concentrations and Hydrochemical Indicators in the Elkhorn Slough Estuary*. AGU Fall Meeting, New Orleans, USA.
- Wood M.M., Tatzel M., **Pit S.**, Kolevica A., Eisenhauer A., Ridgwell A., Hain M., Paytan A. (2020) *Stable and radiogenic strontium isotopes in seawater over the Late Quaternary*. Goldschmidt Conference, virtual.
- Pit S. M.**, & Paytan A. (2019) *Stable and radiogenic Sr isotopes in the ocean across the Paleocene-Eocene Thermal Maximum event as recorded in marine barite*. AGU Fall Meeting, San Francisco, USA.
- Dirksen J.P., **Pit S.M.**, Slomp, C.P., Meijer P. (2019) *Transient model analysis of salinity and oxygen dynamics in the Holocene Black Sea*. Nederlands Aardwetenschappelijk Congres, Utrecht, The Netherlands.

Teaching

Teaching Assistant , University of California, Santa Cruz <i>Air Pollution, Fundamentals of Environmental Processes</i>	2023-2025
Teaching Assistant , Utrecht University <i>Geochemical Processes of the Earth's Surface</i>	2018 - 2019

Service and Outreach

DEI Committee , University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Earth & Planetary Sciences	2025-2026
Graduate Student Representative , University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Earth & Planetary Sciences	2022 – 2024
GEODES leader , University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Earth & Planetary Sciences	2022
Volunteer Community Blue Innovation Festival , Seymour Marine Discovery Center	2022
GEOPATHS mentor , University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Earth & Planetary Sciences	2022
Volunteer Session Leader , Monterey County Expanding Your Horizons STEM conference	2019

Professional Experience

Jr Specialist Researcher <i>US Geological Survey, Pacific Coastal and Marine Sciences Center</i> Task: Working under supervision of Dr. Nancy Prouty (Pacific Coastal and Marine Science Center, USGS) and Prof. Dr. Adina Paytan (UC Santa Cruz, Department of Earth and Planetary Sciences) on a variety of research projects: - Carbon isotopes in authigenic carbonates formed at marine methane seeps. - Classification of morphological features in marine methane seeps. - Trace metal concentrations in fresh and saline waters. - Strontium isotopes in marine barites.	2019 – 2022
Research Assistant <i>US Geological Survey, Pacific Coastal and Marine Sciences Center</i> Task: Worked on nutrient cycling in the Bay of Alaska as recorded by nitrogen isotopes in cold water bamboo corals, under supervision of Dr. Nancy Prouty (Pacific Coastal and Marine Science Center, USGS).	2019 – 2019
Graduate Researcher <i>Earth and Planetary Sciences Department, University of California, Santa Cruz</i> Task: Worked on stable and radiogenic strontium isotopes as recorded in marine barite, under supervision of Prof. Dr. Adina Paytan (UC Santa Cruz, Department of Earth and Planetary Sciences). Lab research conducted through application of column chemistry and mass spectrometry techniques.	2019 – 2019
Laboratory Assistant <i>Department of Earth Sciences, Utrecht University</i> Task: Catalogued a clay mineral collection, and prepared fieldwork materials, under the supervision of Prof. Dr. Thilo Behrends (Utrecht University, Department of Geochemistry).	2018 – 2019
Research Assistant <i>Royal Netherlands Institute for Sea Research (NIOZ)</i> Task: Assisted with the collection of deep-sea sediment samples during the first leg of the Netherlands Initiative Changing Oceans (NICO) expedition, under the supervision of Dr. Lennart de Nooijer (NIOZ, Department of Ocean Systems).	2017 - 2018